

Thomas Zijlstra, CFA

AI Commercialization & Enterprise AI Builder

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Work permit: EU · Switzerland ·
English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

AI commercialization and financial-services professional with 10+ years of experience. Investment banking background until March 2020 in Debt Capital Markets at Société Générale, covering DACH and Benelux FIG clients across senior, covered, and structured products. Since 2020, enterprise AI and digital transformation at Accenture across regulated financial-services clients. Combines commercial judgment, executive stakeholder management, regulated-industry expertise, and working technical capability across agentic workflows, integrations, AI economics, and human-control design.

EXPERIENCE

Accenture, Zurich

Jun 2020 – Present

Financial Services AI & Digital Transformation

- Switzerland NFR Capabilities Team Lead: built and led the local practice, connecting CEE region capabilities and defining go-to-market for non-financial risk.
- NFR practice leadership and go-to-market contribution for the DACH region within the CFO&EV division.
- Originated and led the largest Swiss insurer deal of the year — FINMA regulatory reporting and data adequacy programme.
- Stream Lead for an OeNB central-bank audit at a European core banking provider.
- LIBOR and interest-rate-transition delivery at a European GSIB, applying capital-markets knowledge across derivatives, valuation, and trading-desk structures.
- Developed and implemented AI-agent workflows for RCSA and third-party risk management; built the AI Maturity Assessment for the NFR practice.
- Coordination across business, risk, data, technology, governance, and senior stakeholders.

Société Générale, London

Jun 2015 – Mar 2020

Debt Capital Markets Analyst, FIG — DACH and Benelux (selected UK/Ireland)

- DCM origination, structuring, and execution.
- Senior, Tier 2, covered, RMBS, subordinated, and green-bond products.
- Capital-markets reporting, credit work, liquidity analysis, capacity analysis.
- Coordination with M&A, ECM, Legal, Syndication.
- Derivatives, structured products, IRS, FX options, structured notes.

Catalina, Paris

Jun 2013 – Jan 2014

Data Scientist (Traineeship)

- Consumer and purchasing-behaviour analysis.
- Statistical analysis of transaction data.
- Price-elasticity and product-portfolio analysis.
- Translation of analytical findings into client recommendations.

SELECTED PUBLIC PROJECTS

Enterprise NFR Agent Platform

Public technical demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/RealAIInfrastrucure

- An enterprise-oriented platform combining multiple specialized agent workflows, a knowledge graph, document intelligence, regulatory analysis, human approvals, enterprise integration patterns, and an MCP layer.
- Commercial relevance: Shows how isolated AI use cases can become a reusable platform and expansion path rather than a collection of disconnected pilots.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · no client data · not a production deployment

DORA Article 12 Control Line

Public compliance demonstrator · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/ProReinsuranceAIWorkflow

- A staged workflow connecting a regulatory requirement to control updates, infrastructure proposals, policy verification, compliance documentation, human approval, and an evidence chain.
- Commercial relevance: Turns an abstract regulatory requirement into a bounded, measurable workflow suitable for a paid design partnership.
- Note: Synthetic demonstration · any efficiency estimate is illustrative, not a measured client result

Enterprise AI Economics Simulator

Public executive decision tool · https://github.com/tzijlstra-acn/AICostSimulator

- An interactive cost and scenario tool for estimating the economics of a shared enterprise AI platform, covering industry assumptions, model routing, cloud/sovereign/on-premise scenarios, and cost-vs-gain projections.
- Commercial relevance: Demonstrates the ability to translate technical architecture into buyer-facing economics and proposal content.
- Note: All prices, benchmarks, gains, and allocation values are illustrative planning assumptions.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

CFA Charterholder

CFA Institute

MSc Finance and Investments

2014 – 2015

Rotterdam School of Management, Erasmus University

Cum laude · 8.5/10

Thesis: "Credit rating changes and their effect on asymmetric information"

BSc International Business Administration

2011 – 2014

Rotterdam School of Management

Honours · 8.1/10

CAPABILITIES

Commercial & Strategic

AI commercialization · opportunity qualification · customer discovery · buyer/stakeholder mapping · executive communication · financial modelling · AI economics · proposal development · paid-pilot design · program delivery · commercial hypothesis testing · expansion-playbook design

AI & Architecture

agentic workflows · LangGraph · LangChain · human-in-the-loop · knowledge graphs · document intelligence · model-provider abstraction · evaluation design · AI governance · model-routing and cost models

Engineering & Integration

Python · FastAPI · REST APIs · ServiceNow integration patterns · MCP · NetworkX · SQLite · TypeScript · JavaScript · React · Next.js · HTML/CSS · workflow state machines

Financial Services

Non-Financial Risk · RCSA · TPRM · DORA · AI risk management · regulatory reporting · data adequacy · LIBOR transition · capital markets · FIG · derivatives/valuation concepts

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · German (Fluent) · Dutch (Fluent)